

Aurora Home — Automations and Scenes

App guide · covers release 4.2

What an automation is

An automation is a trigger, an optional set of conditions, and one or more actions. It belongs to a property, may span hubs within that property, and runs on the hub rather than in the app — so it continues to work while your phone is elsewhere.



Conditions are evaluated once, when the trigger fires.

Figure 1: The four parts of an automation, evaluated left to right.

Triggers

Time

A time trigger fires at a fixed clock time on selected days, or at a fixed offset from sunrise or sunset for the property's location. Offsets may be negative.

Sensor

A sensor trigger fires when a contact opens or closes, or when a measured temperature crosses a threshold. Threshold triggers fire on the crossing, not continuously while the condition holds.

Presence

A presence trigger fires when the first person arrives or the last person leaves, based on the phones associated with the account. Presence is deliberately coarse: it does not distinguish who arrived.

Manual

A manual trigger does nothing on its own and is fired from the app. This is how scenes are built — a named set of actions with no automatic trigger at all.

Conditions

Conditions are evaluated once, at the moment the trigger fires. An automation whose condition becomes true a minute later does not run: the trigger has already passed. This catches people out when combining a presence trigger with a temperature condition, and is the single most common misunderstanding in support tickets about automations.

Actions

Actions set a temperature in a zone, activate or clear holiday mode, or send a notification. An action that sets a temperature behaves like a manual setpoint: it holds until the next scheduled setpoint, not indefinitely.

Ordering and conflicts

Where two automations act on the same zone at the same moment, the one created most recently wins. There is no priority setting. If ordering matters, combine the logic into a single automation rather than relying on creation order, which is invisible in the interface and easy to disturb.

Limits

A property supports up to 50 automations. Each automation supports up to 10 actions. Notifications are rate-limited to one per automation per five minutes, so an automation triggered repeatedly will not flood the phone.